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Mark Hietkamp

Vitens

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Beste Mark,

Met deze motivatiebrief wil ik graag solliciteren naar de positie van Medior Engineer bij Vitens. De werkzaamheden en doelstellingen van deze functie spreken mij bijzonder aan. Hoewel ik inmiddels bijna twee jaar in Nederland woon, ben ik de taal nog aan het leren en druk ik mijzelf makkelijker uit in het Engels:

As I have built my academic and professional career around the topic of water, working for a drinking water company such as Vitens is a logical next step. My Bachelor's degree in Environmental Engineering gave me a solid foundation in designing and calculating water distribution systems, which I have since built on through a Master's degree in Water Science and Management at Utrecht University, which I completed this year. I would like to continue applying this knowledge in a role where it really makes a difference.

Since before I started by studies, I have been interested in engineering. With my bachelor's in environmental engineering, I have found a love for the water sector. Planning projects, calculating and designing water distribution systems was a real pleasure. I want to apply my knowledge to projects, that have a direct impact on the quality of life of people. I know how important detailed planning is and how important the role of strong communicator can be. With my diverse background in engineering and also water management, I am confident that I can be the person necessary to keep a safe working space.

During my internship as part of my Bachelor's thesis in Kikinda, Serbia, I worked on the commissioning of a new drinking water treatment plant. In addition to the technical tasks – evaluating parameters for coagulation, flocculation and filtration – I took on project management responsibilities on site, which included ensuring a safe working environment for the on-site staff. This involved conducting safety briefings, monitoring the correct handling of chemicals such as hydrochloric acid and polyaluminium chloride, and ensuring that protocols were followed under conditions of actual operation. Whenever unexpected problems arose, such as pressure drops or parameter deviations, I learnt to systematically diagnose and coordinate efforts to resolve them. The top priority was always to ensure we could reliably supply the city with clean water.

My experience of coordinating safety aspects between technical specialists, staff from local utility companies and external project partners in Serbia have shown me that a clear safety plan depends on communication and the early involvement of the right people. It is not just a matter of documentation. What particularly appeals to me about Vitens is its move towards closer collaboration with contractors. Monitoring and assessing the work of contractors, coordinating with local authorities and other stakeholders, and maintaining quality standards in projects are the areas in which I wish to develop my skills further.

Thank you for considering my application.

Kind regards,

Immanuel Dietrich